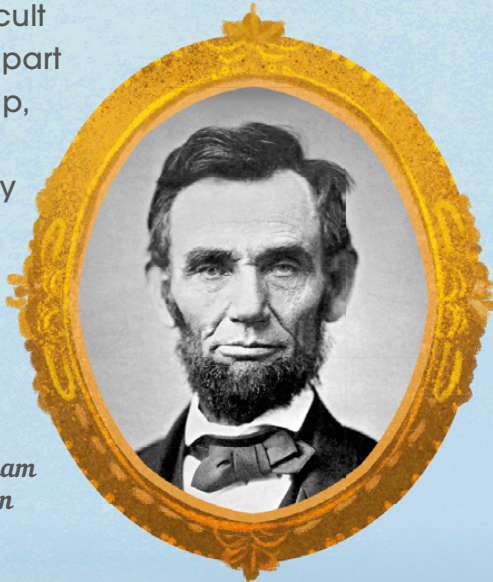


Abraham Lincoln

It took incredible strength to lead the United States when it split in two during the Civil War. Abraham Lincoln—who lived in Springfield, Illinois—was the president during this difficult time. Thanks in part to his leadership, slavery ended and the country was reunited.

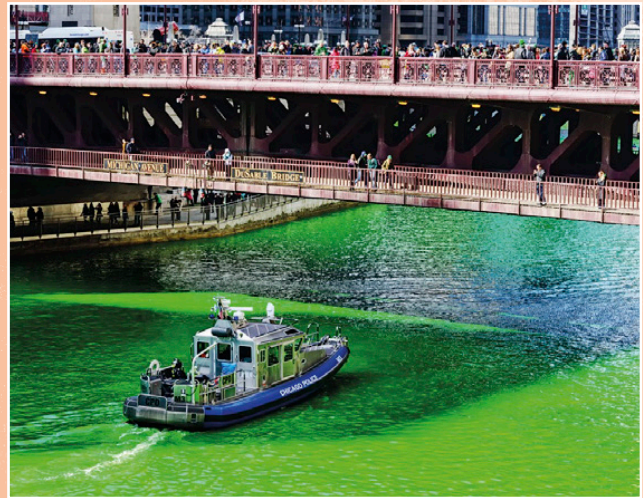


*Abraham
Lincoln*

*A pumpkin field
in Illinois*



*In 1907, the children of Illinois
voted on the state flower.
They chose the violet.*



Chicago River

The Chicago River has some pretty cool bragging rights. In 1887, engineers made the Chicago River to flow backward! And to celebrate St. Patrick's Day, the entire river is dyed bright green!